unit 11 CD3

Conversation — track 15, 17, 18

Quynh is flying home to Vietnam for Tet. Her colleague Lionel is curious.

Lionel: So Tet is basically Vietnamese Christmas, right?

Quynh: Sort of. **It's a bit like** Christmas and New Year rolled into one.

Lionel: Okay, so what does everyone actually do?

Quynh: **Traditionally**, we clean the whole house beforehand. But during Tet itself, no sweeping.

Lionel: Wait, why not?

Quynh: **It's considered** bad luck. You'd be sweeping your good fortune out the door!

Lionel: Love it. And presents? We go a bit overboard at Christmas.

Quynh: Not so much. **It's customary to** give kids lucky money in red envelopes.

Lionel: Cash instead of socks? Those kids have it all figured out.

Quynh: Exactly! Oh, and the first guest of the year matters. **The idea is that** they set the tone.

Study Notes

We go a bit overboard at Christmas.
Nhà tôi mua sắm hơi quá tay vào dịp Giáng sinh.
"go overboard" = làm quá đà (mua sắm, trang trí, ăn uống…).
Cách nói tương đương: We tend to overdo it at Christmas.

Those kids have it all figured out.
Mấy đứa nhỏ đó đúng là biết tính.
"have it all figured out" = hiểu rõ, tính toán đâu ra đấy. Lionel nói đùa: tiền mặt hơn hẳn đôi tất.
Cách nói tương đương: Those kids are onto something.

Speak Like a Native — track 16

1. It's a bit like Christmas and New Year rolled into one.
linking: "rolled_into_one"
weak: "a", "and"
strong: "Christmas", "New Year", "one"
Chữ t trong "Christmas" câm: "kris-mơs". "rolled into one" → "rôl-đin-tu-wăn". Giọng New Zealand không đọc /r/ cuối "Year": "yia".

2. You'd be sweeping your good fortune out the door!
change: "You'd be" (mất âm d)
weak: "your", "the"
strong: "sweeping", "good fortune", "door"
"fortune" /ˈfɔːtʃuːn/ đọc "fo-chun". Giọng New Zealand không đọc /r/ trong "fortune", "door". Giọng vui, hơi cường điệu.

3. Cash instead of socks? Those kids have it all figured out.
linking: "instead_of", "have_it_all", "figured_out"
strong: "Cash", "socks", "figured out"
Giọng Mỹ: "have it all" → "ha-vi-đol" (t → d nhẹ), "figured out" → "fi-gyơr-đao". Lên giọng ở "socks?" vì thích thú.

- Chữ t câm trong Christmas, listen, castle: "kris-mơs", "li-sần", "ca-sồ".
- Giọng New Zealand không đọc /r/ cuối (year, door); giọng Mỹ đọc rõ (figured, overboard).
- Khi giải thích phong tục, nói chậm và nhấn từ khoá: bad luck, lucky money, first guest.
- Nối các từ ngắn thành cụm: rolled_into_one, have_it_all.

Grammar Focus

Mô tả phong tục: Traditionally, … / It's customary to + V

Traditionally = theo truyền thống; It's customary to + V = theo phong tục thì làm gì (trang trọng hơn "people usually…").

Traditionally, the whole family eats together on New Year's Eve.
It's customary to take your shoes off indoors.

Giải thích ý nghĩa: It's considered… / The idea is that… / It's a bit like…

It's considered + tính từ / danh từ: quan niệm chung. The idea is that: giải thích lý do. It's a bit like: so sánh với điều người nghe đã biết.

It's considered rude to point at people.
The idea is that red keeps bad luck away.
It's a bit like Thanksgiving, but longer.

Role Play — track 20

A: So Tet is basically Vietnamese Christmas, right?

B: Sort of. It's a bit like _____ rolled into one.

A: Okay, so what does everyone actually do?

B: Traditionally, we _____ beforehand. But during Tet itself, no sweeping.

A: Wait, why not?

B: It's considered bad luck. You'd be sweeping your good fortune out the door!

A: Love it. And presents? We go a bit overboard at Christmas.

B: Not so much. It's customary to give kids lucky money in red envelopes.

A: Cash instead of socks? Those kids have it all figured out.

B: Exactly! Oh, and the first guest of the year matters. The idea is that they _____.

Substitution Drill — track 21

1. It's a bit like Christmas and New Year rolled into one.
   a. Thanksgiving and New Year
   b. a reunion and a festival
   c. a holiday and a birthday

2. Traditionally, we clean the whole house beforehand.
   a. pay off our debts
   b. visit our ancestors' graves
   c. buy peach blossoms

3. The idea is that they set the tone.
   a. bring good luck
   b. decide your fortune
   c. shape the whole year